

SECTION 2

GROUP MEMBERS

PRINCESS G. TSHITE - ST10442038

SEABELO B. MOTLOUNG - ST10447004

Self-Reflective Report – Seabelo Motlounge

Introduction

The Portfolio of Evidence (PoE) project provided me with the opportunity to apply the practical web development skills that I have learned throughout the module. Our project, called Pastimes, involved designing and developing an online marketplace for buying and selling second-hand clothing in South Africa. The project covered the entire software development process, including research, planning, database design, website development, testing, and evaluation. My primary responsibility within the team was the development of the actual web application. This experience helped me strengthen my technical skills while also improving my ability to work effectively within a team environment.

Role in the Team

My Contribution to the Team

My main contribution was developing the Pastimes web application. I was responsible for creating the website pages, implementing functionality, designing the user interface, and ensuring that the application met the requirements identified during the research and planning phases.

I worked on developing key features such as user registration, login functionality, product listings, shopping cart functionality, and dashboard pages for different user roles. I also assisted with implementing the database structure and ensuring that data could be stored and retrieved correctly.

In addition, I performed testing on the website to identify bugs and ensure that all pages functioned as expected. I communicated regularly with my teammate to ensure that the final application aligned with the documentation and planning completed during earlier phases of the project.

Group Dynamic

The team dynamic was positive because both members had clearly defined responsibilities. While I focused on the technical development of the application, my teammate focused on research, planning, and documentation. This division of responsibilities allowed us to work efficiently while still supporting each other throughout the project.

Regular communication was important because the website development had to match the requirements outlined in the documentation. We shared updates and discussed any changes that needed to be made to ensure consistency throughout the project.

Dealing with Concerns, Queries, and Conflict

Throughout the project, there were occasions when technical challenges delayed development. When concerns arose, we discussed them openly and worked together to find solutions. Queries regarding project requirements were resolved by referring back to the research and planning documents.

Fortunately, major conflicts were minimal because responsibilities were clearly divided. When differences of opinion occurred, we focused on finding solutions that would benefit the project rather than individual preferences.

Research, Technology, and Presentation of Information

Scenario 1: Researching Development Technologies

One task required me to research PHP and MySQL implementation techniques. I needed information on user authentication, session management, and database connectivity. This research helped me implement secure login and registration functionality within the website.

Scenario 2: Researching Responsive Design

Another task involved researching responsive web design practices. Since users may access the website using different devices, I needed to understand how to create layouts that adapt to various screen sizes. This information helped improve the user experience across desktop and mobile devices.

Personal Strengths and Weaknesses

Tasks I Did Well

- Website development and coding.
- Database implementation.
- Testing website functionality.
- Solving technical problems.
- Creating responsive web pages.

Five Strengths I Identified

1. Technical problem-solving skills.
2. Attention to detail.
3. Ability to learn new technologies.
4. Persistence when facing challenges.
5. Good time management under pressure.

Tasks I Did Not Perform Well In

- Some advanced PHP functionality required additional research.
- Debugging complex errors sometimes took longer than expected.
- Documentation was not my strongest area.

Reasons for These Challenges

My difficulties mainly resulted from limited practical experience with some advanced development concepts. While I understood the theory, implementing certain features required additional learning and experimentation.

How I Can Improve

To improve, I plan to continue practising web development through personal projects and online tutorials. I also want to improve my debugging techniques and become more confident working with databases and server-side programming.

Conclusion

The Pastimes project was an excellent learning experience that allowed me to apply my web development knowledge in a practical setting. I gained valuable technical skills and learned how important teamwork and communication are during software development projects. Although I faced some challenges, they helped me grow as a developer and increased my confidence in building web applications.

Self-Reflective Report – Princess Tshite

Introduction

The Portfolio of Evidence (PoE) project gave me an opportunity to participate in the planning, research, and documentation of a real-world web application called Pastimes. The aim of the project was to create an online platform for buying and selling second-hand clothing in South Africa. Throughout the project, I was primarily responsible for conducting research, gathering information, preparing documentation, and ensuring that all project requirements were clearly presented. This experience strengthened my research, communication, organisation, and documentation skills while helping me understand the importance of planning within the software development process.

Role in the Team

My Contribution to the Team

My primary responsibility was completing the research and documentation required for the project. I conducted competitor analysis on platforms such as Yaga and ThredUp and identified features that could be incorporated into the Pastimes website.

I was responsible for compiling project documentation, including the project overview, user requirements, sitemap, user roles, database planning, ERD descriptions, system functions, and written reports required for the PoE. I ensured that all information was organised clearly and professionally.

In addition, I communicated with my teammate to ensure that the documentation accurately reflected the functionality being developed within the website.

Group Dynamic

The group worked effectively because responsibilities were divided according to our strengths. While my teammate focused on technical development, I focused on research and documentation. This allowed us to complete tasks more efficiently while supporting each other when needed.

The communication between us was positive and professional. We regularly shared updates and ensured that our work remained aligned throughout the project.

Dealing with Concerns, Queries, and Conflict

Whenever questions arose regarding project requirements, I referred to the assignment guidelines and research findings to provide clarity. Any concerns about deadlines or project progress were discussed openly and resolved through communication.

Because responsibilities were clearly defined, major conflicts did not occur. Any minor disagreements were handled respectfully and professionally.

Research, Technology, and Presentation of Information

Scenario 1: Competitor Research

One important task required me to research existing second-hand clothing platforms. I analysed Yaga and ThredUp to understand their strengths, weaknesses, and features. This research helped our team determine which features should be included in the Pastimes application.

Scenario 2: Database and System Planning Research

Another task required me to gather information regarding database design and system planning. I researched how users, products, orders, and messages interact within an e-commerce platform. This information helped create accurate documentation, ERD descriptions, and database planning documents.

Personal Strengths and Weaknesses

Tasks I Did Well

- Conducting research.
- Writing project documentation.
- Organising information.
- Creating project reports.
- Presenting information clearly and professionally.

Five Strengths I Identified

1. Strong research skills.
2. Excellent written communication.
3. Good organisational skills.
4. Attention to detail.
5. Ability to work independently and meet deadlines.

Tasks I Did Not Perform Well In

- Technical coding tasks.
- Understanding some advanced development concepts.
- Database implementation activities.

Reasons for These Challenges

My role focused mainly on research and documentation rather than programming. As a result, I had less exposure to technical implementation and found some coding concepts challenging to understand in detail.

How I Can Improve

To improve, I would like to develop a stronger understanding of web development technologies such as HTML, CSS, PHP, and MySQL. Learning more about the technical side of projects will help me contribute more broadly in future group assignments.

I also plan to continue improving my research and writing skills by practising academic and professional report writing.

Conclusion

The Pastimes project was a rewarding learning experience that helped me develop valuable research, planning, and documentation skills. I learned the importance of detailed preparation and effective communication within a project team. The experience highlighted both my strengths and areas for improvement and has prepared me for future academic and professional projects.